

The Top Trends At CES 2005

1. Digital TV Gets Cheaper And Cheaper: We've chronicled this on ExtremeTech, but the trend is only going to accelerate. With



approaching \$1,500, ultrathin tube-TVs rivaling rear-projection models, and amazingly cheap three-LCD RPTVs that may just rival DLP and plasma, it will be easier and cheaper to replace that aging tube TV with a digital-capable set. And with all the new factories coming on line, expect prices to continue their inexorable slide.

2. Post-HDTV World Is Coming:

or 1080i. But the industry is already envisioning a world of progressive scan 1080-double the resolution of the biggest current sets. The plasmas and DLP projectors on display supporting 1080p looked great. Alas, we may not have much content to take advantage of these great-looking displays.

3. Not Now For High-Definition DVD: Both Blu-ray and HD-DVD are ready to go, and vendors were showing off drives and players for each. Alas, with two competing standards-and high-profile announcements of support for each-neither will take off over the next 18 months. Even though current DVDs look a bit pale on today's modern HDTVs, don't expect anything substantial until late 2006. And if the warring factions can't get their act together, it could stretch out into 2008 or later. To quote Bugs Bunny, "What a bunch of maroons!"

4. Home Media Networking Will Be Big: Yes, we all will be moving our media around the house and to portable devices. But the question is, “When will someone get it right?” I looked at networking schemes from TiVo, DivX, DirecTV, and many others. Someone will figure this one out, but none of the current solutions are easy enough, or transparent enough, for most consumers. Only startup Sonos seemed to understand the need for simplicity, but its products are audio-only and expensive.

5. DVR Is A Feature, Not A Product: Back when TiVo and ReplayTV launched, the digital video recorder seemed to be the next big electronics product, after DVD. But over the last five years, hard-drive and flash-based media recording have become pervasive. DVR is rapidly becoming part of many consumer devices, from satellite radio to set top boxes. DirecTV rolled out its own homegrown versions, joining Motorola, Scientific Atlanta, and more. Even TiVo realizes that DVR alone is not enough, as it rolled out additional services and connectivity designed to turn its box into the hub of the digital home. Anyone planning on building a standalone DVR ought to have their head examined.

Read the full piece at www.snipurl.com/digit ces

When you gotta...

This ad nicely gets across the message that you can, indeed, build a truly portable desktop. The pun complements the visual very nicely, too.



An extension of yourself

Based on a simple theme, this ad gets across the overt idea of the smartphone being able to do many things at the same time, and the subtle message that it can act as ‘an extension of you’.